

Bob Ingram 'As I Was Saying ...'

Gordie Avery Is Missing

COLLECTION OF NOTES after weekending at Equatorial-like Holtville, Calif., which calls itself the carrot capital of the world and where more than 100 young players are training for jobs with the Sun Kings and other clubs in the California Angel chain.

Gordon Avery was missing. Avery, the favorite of El Paso fans for the last two seasons because of his hustling play at second base and winner of the award the Angels present to the player who shows the greatest amount of desire in the farm camp of the Angels, has apparently quit baseball. He probably saw no future in it after his troubles with the bat a year ago.

Bobby Trevino, the Mexico youth who looked so good hitting as a Sun King last season that the Angels called him up directly to their club, has a pulled leg muscle and is not playing or practicing now. He'll be all right by the time the Sun Kings need him for the opening game of the season. Wally Wolf, who looks somewhat heavier than he did a year ago, said after being returned to the Angel organization, he didn't know why the Oakland organization didn't want him. He said he didn't pitch a ball in an exhibition or intra-squad game.

Tanner and 'Tanya'

THE NAME of a sun tan lotion in Hawaii is called "Tanya." It fits in pretty well with the last name of Chuck Tanner, who will manage the Hawaiian Islanders in the Pacific Coast League. An advertising suggestion was one in which a picture of Tanner showed him using the lotion with the caption saying: "Tanya on Tanner."

Another story was told about Don Wilkinson, the outfielder, making a commercial for Gillette, maker of shaving blades as well as razors. His name would better fit a rival shaving blade. Hy Zimmerman, the Seattle sports writer who was covering the Pilots who played an exhibition Sunday at Holtville, recalled the time when the Seattle club of the Pacific Coast League played in Mexicali and the announcer pronounced the name of Jarvis Tatum as "HarVIS TeyTOOM." Chuck Tanner, recalling again that winning the Texas League pennant last year was the big thrill of his life, said El Paso seemed like home to him. Re-living the pennant drive here, Tanner said Roland Hemond, the California club farm director, deserved a lot of the credit because "he wouldn't let 'em take some of the players away from El Paso," meaning Seattle didn't get to riddle the Sun Kings lineup as has been done in some of the past seasons.

Ace Relievers Below Par

BILL BOEHLERT and Steve Kealey, the "gold dust" relief pitching twins of the Sun Kings a year ago, haven't had very good spring seasons. In fact, it's been mediocre. Hemond, the farm director, indicated as much, but said that on the basis of their gilt-edged relief performance with El Paso a year ago, they will be advanced to Hawaii. Then they'll be on their own.

Boehlert attended Syracuse University during the winter. The Angel organization seems to be "down" on Jim Holbrook and the inference is that he's about to be released despite the fact that the Boston right hander was the Kings' big stopper against Albuquerque last season when the Dodgers got off to a good start and threatened to run away with the pennant.

Winston Llenas, the little infielder who played two seasons with El Paso, will not likely come back here if he doesn't make it with Hawaii. Hemond indicated that he'll be traded or sold.

Ed Hurley of El Paso who'll umpire in the Texas League again this season is working the Holtville games. He told about the time he was umpiring a game at Little Rock last season between the Arkansas team and another club. He pulled a ball out of his pocket to throw to the pitcher. He looked at it, and it said, "Little Rock Little League."

In an intra-squad game at Holtville, Del Rice of the Sun Kings played second base on one team and Tom Morgan, ex-Yankee hurler who will manage San Jose this year, played first on the other team. Morgan was hit in the head with the ball when he slid into second base and was cut on the arm. On the final play of the game, he was camped under a pop up near the first base bag. The batter running to first hit Morgan and knocked him flat. Morgan had words with the player and Hemond, sitting in the stands, seemed disturbed about the incident and hustled over to talk to the brash rookie. Wonder if the Angels have a farm club in Siberia where he can be sent?